

might make LiveDrive an overkill for general users, but if you want a feature-packed backup service with the fewest limitations LiveDrive is your answer.

Dos and don'ts of online data backup

Online data backup on the face of it seems like a reliable option. There is whole platoon of services that allow you to store, share and sync files on the cloud. These services also promise you security and reliability, but the truth remains that cloud based services are prone to failures too. The user must keep in mind a few limitations of the cloud and make an informed choice before jumping the bandwagon or following the crowd.

- ▶ For data backup it is advisable to use a full blown cloud storage option rather than a sync-store option such as Dropbox, as file encryption is not its powerful suite. Dropbox, Skydrive etc can be used to store basic files such as images, documents etc, but when it comes to backup of important and heavy data it is preferable to use Cloud Storage options such as JustCloud and Carbonite.
- ▶ It is almost mandatory to have a fast and reliable internet connection if you are using any cloud-based application since all cloud based apps rely on the internet as a communication and transfer medium. A bad internet connection will seriously hamper cloud based operations and may also cause loss of data during syncing
- ▶ Remember to always have a plan B. Cloud Storage services are not 100 per cent secure. They are still prone to natural disasters, outages and security breaches. It really wouldn't hurt to have your data backed up on a secondary cloud in addition to your primary cloud backup.
- ▶ Cloud Services ensure maximum security but is also the user's responsibility to be vigilant from his/her side. Users must set proper authentication rules that define who can access what. Verification methods can be put in for this purpose.
- ▶ Online Cloud Storage is fancy, but a personal hard drive is still the way to backup extremely sensitive data. Also, remember not to share copyrighted files online, or it could land you in trouble. 